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Document Code: SOP-10	CONTROL AND HANDLING NON CONFORMITIES		

Introduction

This procedure provides the directions for control and handling non-conformities according to the requirements of sub clause 7.10 of PNS ISO/IEC 17025:2017 standard.

1. Responsibilities & Authorities

1. Laboratory Manager
2. Quality Assurance Manager
3. Technical Manager
4. Laboratory Analysts

2. Definition of Non-Conformities

2.1. Non-conformity is referred to as any deviation from the specifications of the quality management system, as described in the Standard Operating Procedures and Work Instructions procedures, which directly or indirectly affect the testing work, the quality of service to the customer and the implementation of the quality management system.

2.2. Non-conformities are normally detected during routine checks in every day operation. Typical cases of non-conformities may be:

1. Partial fulfillment of quality management system specifications
2. Damage of samples for testing
3. Deviation of environmental conditions from specified limits
4. Damage of equipment of BFAR RFL XII
5. Inappropriate use of documents, forms and elements of the quality management system
6. Required step in the procedure is not carried out or documented
7. Use of equipment not calibrated or other equipment problem
8. Documents are found to have erroneous information during checks or audits;
9. Result fails to meet quality control criteria.
10. Customer complaints

3. Recording and Handling of Non-Conformities

3.1. Recording of non-conformity is carried out by any staff by filling out the LF 10-01, Non-Conformity Form and relating the non-conformity to the respective procedure of the quality management system.

Prepared by: MA. MAURICE A. BANQUILING Quality Assurance Manager	Reviewed and Approved by: EUGENE GAY B. JAMORA Laboratory Manager
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Republic of the Philippines
Department of Agriculture
BUREAU OF FISHERIES AND AQUATIC RESOURCES
REGIONAL FISHERIES LABORATORY XII
J. Catolico St., Lagao, General Santos City

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- 3.2. Non-conformity forms are forwarded to the Quality Assurance Manager, who assigns the resolution of non-conformities to the respective member of the staff according to its nature and laboratory unit.

4. Resolution of Non-Conformities and Cause Analysis

- 4.1. Any non-conformity is examined to find out its root cause (root cause analysis) and to find immediate resolution to the problem.
- 4.2. Implementation of actions to resolve/restore non-conformities may require approval by the Laboratory Manager depending upon their nature and the requirements.
- 4.3. The results of the cause analysis, the definition of the actions for resolutions and the results of its implementation are described in the LF 10-01, Non-Conformity Form, which is returned to the Quality Assurance Manager.
- 4.4. Action plans are implemented to answer nonconformities.

Nonconformities resulting to stop operations are as follows:

- Supplies below ordering point
 - Equipment malfunction
 - Electrical short-circuits
 - Power interruption
 - Water shortage
 - Manpower lay-off
 - Natural calamities
- 4.5. The effectiveness of actions plans is implemented (follow-ups).
- 4.6. If actions are effective, clear-out/close the nonconformity. If not, then issue another nonconformity. Update LF 15-01, Risks and Opportunities Register.
- 4.7. All actions that are taken are to be documented.
- 4.8. The LF 10-02, Corrective Actions Log is updated.
- 4.9. Customers are informed of failed test results through phone or e-mail by the Customer Service Officer with the approval of the Technical Manager or laboratory analysts and will be recorded in LF 06-02, Request for Laboratory Analysis.
- 4.10 Laboratory manager has the authority to halt operation of laboratory activities due to nonconformities specified in 4.4.

Prepared by: MA. MAURICE A. BANQUILING Quality Assurance Manager	Reviewed and Approved by: EUGENE GAY B. JAMORA Laboratory Manager
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4.11. Laboratory manager also has the authority to resume operations of lab activities when such nonconformities are resolved.

5. Corrective Actions

5.1. The Quality Assurance Manager along with the involved staff of par.4, examine the need for corrective actions with main criteria:

1. Frequency of this type or similar type of non-conformities
2. Severity of damage and/or cost for BFAR RFL XII and the customers
3. Consequences of similar non-conformities for BFAR RFL XII and the customers in the future

5.2. Corrective actions, as long as they are undertaken, are recorded in the respective field of the LF 10-01, Non-conformity Form.

6. Control of Implementation

6.1. The Quality Assurance Manager is responsible for the control of the implementation of all actions specified in the procedure (par. 4, 5).

6.2. It is noted that throughout the implementation of all assigned actions (par.4 and 5), the Non-Conformity Form (LF 10-01) remains in the possession of the staff member responsible for its implementation. As soon as the actions are completed, the form is returned to the Quality Assurance Manager, who examines and files the form.

7. Documents

LF 10-01, Non-Conformity Form

LF 10-02, Corrective Actions Log

LF 15-01, Risks and Opportunities Register

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8. Document History

Revision No.	Issue Date	Original Entry	Revised as	Recall Date

Prepared by:

MA. MAURICE A. BANQUILING
Quality Assurance Manager

Reviewed and Approved by:

EUGENE GAY B. JAMORA
Laboratory Manager